Township of NIPISSING
"Life the way it should be" 1888

The Corporation of the Township of Nipissing
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REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: August 13, 2024

From: John-Paul Negrinotti, Land Planning & Technology Administrator – Deputy Treasurer
Kim Turnbull, Deputy Clerk, Interim, Office Assistant-Intern

Re: Website and Social Media Updates

BACKGROUND/OVERVIEW

Council identified in the 2023-2026 Strategic Plan a commitment to ensuring the Township provides effective and efficient communication to residents and visitors while delivering municipal services and meeting the expectations of the community.

The recent 2024 Community Survey identified that enhancement could be made to the Township's webpage to ensure residents and visitors are able to find accurate, concise information in a timely manner.

STRATEGIC PLAN LINKAGE

The website and social media enhancement and updates supports Council's focus of **"Effective and Efficient Municipal Services"** and **"Sustainable Community Growth and Prosperity"** of the Strategic Plan.

SUMMARY

With the website upgrade to the newest version of the Wordpress platform, which is included in our annual web page cost, it allows for the Township to have greater flexibility in the format of posts on the website. For example: Columns with pictures, as seen with the "Celebrating Public Works Week" post. Most recently, the hosting platform update from PHP 7 to PHP 8, will improve security, website speed and efficiency resulting in a performance increase. (PHP – Hypertext Pre-Processor)

Ongoing enhancements are being made to the various pages on the website to ensure accurate information along with links to outside resources where appropriate. Training to staff, to provide options for secondary pages from a primary page on the website to allow users to find information quickly. For example – Administration – Freedom of Information.

The Planning Webpage has been reformatted to include comprehensive information for users on how to book a pre-consultation meeting, information on minor variance applications, consents/severance applications and more. These enhancements will provide some

background information and assist in answering questions users may have before contacting the Township office.

To promote the businesses of the Township of Nipissing we will be reaching out to the businesses currently listed in our directory to update the information and ask for 1 (one) picture to include with their listing. This will support local business and the Township's desire for sustainable growth.

To reach new local businesses in the Township a post will be made through Social Media, on the Township's Facebook page and the website asking them for their information to be forwarded to the Township to be included in the Business Directory.

The Township has a number of Facebook accounts to reach the broader community to communicate information on a variety of topics. All municipal departments have access to the software Canva, to create posts to communicate public notices, events or information on the Township's behalf. A standardized template has been developed with the Township's branded colours allowing the community to identify posts by the Township.

Recommendations

To continue updating the Township website to provide ease of use for all users. Ensure all available and relevant information is posted in a timely accurate manner to the website and where applicable a social media post is sent out.

Work with the respective departments and staff to update the information on the website to reflect the most current information. Link outside resources when applicable and appropriate for residents, for example MPAC new homeowners' information.

Begin the campaign to update the Business Directory for residents and visitors to have a comprehensive resource to access.

Respectfully,

John-Paul Negrinotti, Land Planning & Technology Administrator – Deputy Treasurer

Kim Turnbull, Deputy Clerk, Interim Office Assistant-Intern

Celebrating Public Works Week!

May 19-25, 2024

This year's theme is: **Advancing Quality of Life for All**







Since 1960, municipalities across Canada have recognized National Public Works Week. This week in May is used to educate, engage and inform the public about the essential role public works plays in their community's life.

A snap shot of what our Public Works Crew oversees:

- 300 lane km of Roadways; including snow plowing, ditching and brushing.
- Over 500 Road Culverts
- 2 landfill sites; Wolfe Lake and Bear Creek
- 2 Public Boat Launches
- 2 Public Docks
- 1 Public Park – Heritage Park, 14 Blake Street
- 2 Public Beaches: Links Beach and Wolfe Lake Beach
- 3 Cemeteries

Final 2024 Property Tax Bills



The 2024 Final Tax Bills have been mailed out and are due **September 30th, 2024**

For all of your payment options, visit our website: www.NipissingTownship.com Municipal Info - Tax Info

Township of NIPISSING

Visit Us: www.NipissingTownship.com Contact Us: 705-724-2144

Water Level & Flow Information



For Lake Nipissing

A recorded message is available at **1-866-763-2300** from Public Services & Procurement Canada

Advising on the changing water levels on Lake Nipissing. As of April 16, Caution has been issued with Rising Lake Levels. The next update will be on April 19, 2024

The Sturgeon-Nipissing-French Citizens' Advisory Group, will continue to closely monitor the weather conditions and water levels in an attempt to minimize the impact of variable weather conditions and maximize the benefits to the fishery of the lake and river.

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Soccer Cancelled - June 13th, 2024 due to the threat of thunderstorms and lightening and the wet field conditions.



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Public Notice



McQuaby Lake Boat Ramp Upcoming Work

On Monday July15th or Tuesday July 16th the Boat Ramp at McQuaby Lake will be closed.

To allow for work to be completed due to unsafe conditions. The Ramp will be returned to natural material to allow for continued use of the ramp. Replacement of the ramp is anticipated in the 2025 Budget.

We thank you for your patience during this time.

Visit Us: www.NipissingTownship.com Contact Us: 705-724-2144

Victoria Day Hours

The Township Office will be closed, Monday May 20, 2024

Reopening Tuesday May 21, 2024 at 8:30 a.m.

Wolfe Lake Landfill will be closed, Monday May 20, 2024. Regular Landfill hours will resume, Wednsday May 22, 2024

For immediate information, please visit: www.NipissingTownship.com For road emergencies, please call 705-724-2194



Visit Us: www.NipissingTownship.com Contact Us: 705-724-2144

Planning

You need to submit **Planning Act** applications to the Township of Nipissing if you'd like to propose a new development. This includes:

- Plan of Subdivision
- Official Plan Amendment
- Zoning By-law Amendment
- Site Plan Control
- Consent/Severance
- Minor Variances

Book A Pre-Consultation Meeting

Prior to submitting a Planning Act application, we recommend that you book a pre-consultation with the Land Planning Administrator, **edo@nipissingtownship.com** When scheduling a pre-consultation meeting, please submit a site plan of the overall proposed development and any other details you may have that can assist staff with understanding the proposal. We can review your application and make sure that you have all necessary documents and approvals before you submit.

Minor Variance Applications

A Minor Variance application provides specific relief from the Township's **Zoning By-Law** if the **Committee of Adjustment** agrees that the request is minor. Minor Variances must maintain the general intent of the Zoning By-Law and Official Plan.

Please contact us for a copy of the application. We're happy to provide you with the application form and submission instructions.

Fees: There is an administration fee, non-refundable of $500.00 and a refundable deposit of $1,500.00 (plus actual costs as required) to submit a minor variance application. We accept payment in cash, debit, or cheque. Please make cheques payable to Township of Nipissing.

Application Details:
Please ensure you have the following information as part of your application:

- sketch or site plan
- photographs of the existing buildings on the property as digital files
- elevation drawing and floor plan clearly showing the existing structure and/or proposed addition or structure, if applicable
- copies of any correspondence, approvals or permits from outside agencies

Consent/Severance Applications

If you'd like to apply for a land severance or consent, such as the creation of a new lot, addition to an existing lot or the granting of right-of-way, you'll need approval from the **Committee of Adjustment.**

Please contact us for a copy of the application. We're happy to provide you with the application form and submission instructions.

Consent Application Processing Procedure

Official Plan:

Nipissing Official Plan in Effect As of April 11, 2018

Appendix A – Source Protection Features
Appendix B – Wildland Fire

Schedule A: Land Use
Schedule B – Natural Heritage, Other Features & Natural Resources

Official Plan Amendment No. 1

Committee Of Adjustment:

Application: Minor Variance

Application: Consent

Consent Procedure

Road Closing Application:

Application and Instructions

Zoning By-Law:

Zoning By-law No. 2020-20 – PASSED December 1, 2020

Amendments To Zoning By-Law 2020-20, As Amended:

5.13 Special Zone No. 13 (678 Sunset Cove Road)
5.14 Special Zone No.14 (3850 Highway 654)
5.14 Special Zone No.15 (3758 Alsace Road)
Removal of a Holding (H) Symbol (3292 Highway 534)
By-Law No. 2022-26 (1945 Alsace Road)
By-Law No. 2022-23 Trailers, Motor Homes and Campers
By-Law No. 2022-41 (Con 10 PT Broken: Lot 29, Duncan Lake)
Removal of Holding (H) Symbol (2675 Highway 654)

5.16 Special Zone No. 16 (Lake Nipissing Road)
By-Law 2022-57 (165 Muskeg Road)
By-Law 2023-22 and Removal a Holding (H) Symbol (3568 Highway 534)
By-Law 2024-05 (118 Chapman's Landing Road)